

Going to college

Going to college isn't just about getting a degree. It's an exciting chance to study different subjects, have unique experiences, and make new friends.

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Weighing options

As well as gaining qualifications and enhancing job prospects, many teens find college a great opportunity to make new friends, try out new hobbies and interests, and gain independence, but there are disadvantages to consider, too.

► Pros and cons

Choosing whether or not to go to college can be a big decision.

Advantages:



- Gain a degree, a qualification valued by employers
- Learn skills that are transferrable into a workplace
- Expand knowledge about a favorite subject
- Gather life skills and experience by living independently
- Have lots of fun!

Disadvantages:



- Fees and living expenses can be costly
- No guarantee of a job at the end

Choosing the right college

There are lots of things to consider when deciding what colleges to apply to. For many teens, the biggest factors to think about are whether a college offers the course they want to study and if they meet its entry requirements.

▽ Making a decision

There are so many colleges that picking which ones to apply to can be hard. Here are the main things to consider.

Subjects

Are traditional academic subjects or vocational subjects of more interest?



Future career

How easy it is to get a job with this degree after graduation?



Entry requirements

Which college has the most realistic entry requirements? It's best to apply to a range of colleges.



Reputation

What reputation does the college have? How important is this to you?



Location

Is there somewhere you've always wanted to live? Do you prefer big cities or small towns?



Assessment methods

Are essays and projects, exams, or tutorials used to assess grades?

